

Agile Values

Lecture 02

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Case Study Continued.

Agile to the Rescue! (Right?)



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A Fractured Perspective in Agile

- When many developers first encounter agile, they immediately see it as a set of **tools**, **techniques**, and **practices**.
- But seeing only the tools, techniques, and practices is just the first step in “going agile”.
- This has a problematic side effect.

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A Fractured Perspective in Agile

- Developer concentrates mainly on things that directly affect development.
 - Improve the code by removing or preventing bugs.
 - Tools that make builds faster and easier to run.
 - Practices that improve the way th



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A Fractured Perspective in Agile

- Project manager cares about how much work it will take to build the software and the quality of the results.
- Tools that help to understand and communicate schedules, estimates, and effort.



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A Fractured Perspective in Agile

- Team leads want to make sure that everyone on the team is moving in the same direction, communicating well, and learning from their experiences.



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A Fractured Perspective in Agile

- A business user generally interested in the value that the software delivers to the business.
- Attracted to practice that helps the team understand exactly what the users need.



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Example: Writing User Stories



- Each team member sees user stories a little differently.
 - Away that user stories helps him or her personally

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Fractured Perspective in Agile

- When each person thinks only about his role and doesn't look past it to see how the entire team uses them it can cause exactly the kind of problem that their past waterfall projects ran into.
- This called a **fractured perspective**, because everyone has a different view of the agile practice.
- Leads to **better-than-not-doing-it** results.

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Result of Fractured Perspective

- More people focus on their own goals, and not on the goals of the team, the less likely it's going to be that what they deliver has real value for the company.
- Teams that concentrate only on the individual practices do end up seeing improvement, but only in the areas that they're already pretty good at.

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Result of Fractured Perspective

- That's why a team get better than-not-doing-it results.
- They've applied better practices to the things that they already do, so they'll do those things better.
- They might nit have paid attention to areas that don't appeal to anyone.

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The Agile Manifesto Helps Teams See the Purpose Behind Each Practice !



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Agile Manifesto

- The **Manifesto for Agile Software development**, was created in 2001.
- At the Snowbird Retreat in the mountains outside of Salt Lake City, Utah.
- A group of 17 like-minded people.
- Agreed on a core set of ideas and principles including the term “**agile**”.
- Bundled them into a single document.

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Manifesto for Agile Software Development

We are uncovering better ways of developing software by doing it and helping others do it. Through this work we have come to value:

Individuals and interactions over processes and tools

Working software over comprehensive documentation

Customer collaboration over contract negotiation

Responding to change over following a plan

That is, while there is value in the items on the right, we value the items on the left more.

www.agilemanifesto.org

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Individuals and Interactions Over Processes and Tools

- People can go wrong when they blindly follow a process.
- A great tool can sometimes helps do the wrong thing faster.
- It's important to understand the people on the team.
 - how they work together
 - how each person's work impacts everyone else

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Individuals and Interactions Over Processes and Tools

- If the people who need to use a process or tool don't buy into it, it will fall by the wayside.
- People may follow the letter of the process, even if it leads to incoherent results.
- There are many agile practices that support this principle.
 - Daily standup meetings
 - Retrospectives
 - User stories

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Working Software Over Comprehensive Documentation

- There is so much that can be documented in a software project.
- Lot of teams document every little thing.
- Although there is no potential reader for the document.
- Working software is software that adds value to the organization.
- For a project to add value, it needs to deliver or save more money than it cost to build.

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Working Software Over Comprehensive Documentation

- There are many kinds of documents that are very useful for the team.
 - Wireframes
 - Sequence diagrams
- When the team works on documentation that is clearly headed toward working software, it's making a positive contribution to the project.

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Customer Collaboration Over Contract Negotiation

- When programmers, testers, business owners, and project managers all work on different teams, and don't really collaborate toward a single goal of delivering working software.
- They often treat each other as if they're working on a contract.
- In many companies, they will explicitly discuss SLAs (service-level agreements) between teams.

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Customer Collaboration Over Contract Negotiation

- This may reduce the risk of getting in trouble with the boss.
- Because it makes it easier to point a finger and blame another team for failing to deliver software.
- But it is highly counterproductive if the goal is to get working software out the door for the users.

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Customer Collaboration Over Contract Negotiation

- A way agile teams put this value in place is to have a product owner who is a real, first-class member of the team.
- Product owner may not be actively developing code, but she does attend meetings, contribute ideas, and, most importantly, feel ownership for the final product.

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Responding to Change Over Following a Plan

- Plan the work, work the plan.
- If you work the wrong plan, you'll build the wrong product.
- Teams need to constantly look for changes, and to make sure that they respond appropriately when there's a change in what the users need, or in how the software needs to be built.

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Responding to Change Over Following a Plan

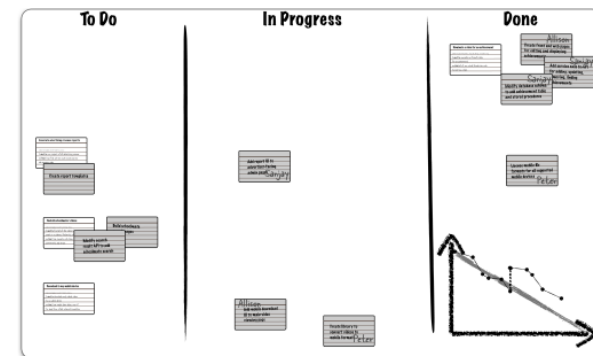
- People who built a plan to resist change, because it takes work to change a plan.
- If the change is really needed, it will be much harder to make it later on, after the code is more complete.
- A **task board** is a good example of a practice that helps a team make the right decisions about responding to changes.

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Responding to Change Over Following a Plan



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Principles Over Practices

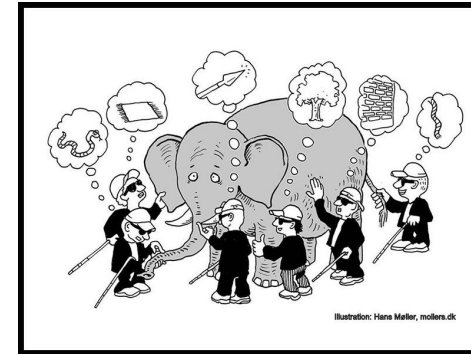
- There's a mindset of agile that goes beyond practices.
- A team that uses the agile practices to help attain the goal of building working software that customers value through interaction, collaboration, and responding to change will get more out of their projects than the team that simply adopts better planning, programming, and documentation practices.

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Understanding the Elephant



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Blind Men and the Elephant

Six blind men were asked to determine what an elephant looked like by feeling different parts of the elephant's body. The blind man who feels a leg says the elephant is like a pillar; the one who feels the tail says the elephant is like a rope; the one who feels the trunk says the elephant is like a tree branch; the one who feels the ear says the elephant is like a hand fan; the one who feels the belly says the elephant is like a wall; and the one who feels the tusk says the elephant is like a solid pipe.

A king explains to them: "All of you are right. The reason every one of you is telling it differently is because each one of you touched the different part of the elephant. So, actually the elephant has all the features you mentioned."

https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Blind_men_and_an_elephant

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Understanding the Elephant

- In a fractured agile adoption, each person uses only the practices that impact his or her work, the same way each of the blind men feels only one part of the elephant.
 - Developers concentrate on, test-driven development, refactoring, and automated builds.
 - Project managers like task boards, project velocity, and burn-down charts.

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Methodologies Help You Get It All in Place at Once!



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